



FREE GUIDE · FOR SPECIALTY PHARMACIES

The Specialty Pharmacy's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

High-cost biologics, hazardous drugs, and cold-chain —
recover credit and stay compliant.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

High-cost product, high-stakes waste.

Specialty pharmacies dispense high-cost biologics and complex therapies — which makes credit recovery on returnable product especially valuable, and hazardous-drug and cold-chain handling especially important. Get reverse distribution right and you recover real money; get hazardous drugs wrong and it's a citation. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

As a DEA-registered reverse distributor we recover credit on your returnable high-cost biologics and destroy the rest — controlled, hazardous, and non-controlled — with a Certificate of Destruction and no contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Reverse distribution & returns

Your biggest opportunity — returnable high-cost biologics can carry significant manufacturer credit.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused returnable Rx
- Overstock & discontinued inventory
- Manufacturer recalls
- Brand & generic stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Opened / adulterated product (destroy only)
- Patient-owned meds
- Sharps

THE RULE · Returnable items are processed for manufacturer credit; non-returnable items are rendered non-retrievable with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical reverse distribution — credit recovered, the rest destroyed.

Tip

Items you'd have thrown away may still be credit-eligible — don't pre-sort them into the trash.

WASTE STREAM 02

RCRA-hazardous drugs

Many oncology and specialty agents are RCRA-hazardous — the stream with the highest citation risk.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- P-listed (warfarin $\geq 0.3\%$, nicotine, epinephrine)
- U-listed drugs
- Characteristic waste (ignitable, toxic)
- Certain chemotherapy agents

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous pharmaceuticals
- Controlled substances (own path)

THE RULE · EPA RCRA — identify P/U-listed and characteristic drugs, segregate, and destroy to EPA standards; know your generator status.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit.

Tip

Nicotine and epinephrine are P-listed — easy to miss and a common citation.

WASTE STREAM 03

Controlled substances

Schedule II–V specialty and supportive-care drugs.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V stock
- Returns of controls (per program)
- Partial & wasted doses

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — Form 222 for Schedule II transfers, Form 41 for surrendered controls, and non-retrievable destruction with records.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance mail-back / reverse distribution, to DEA standards.

Tip

We're a DEA-registered reverse distributor — the credential that makes taking back your controls legal.

WASTE STREAM 04

Pharmaceutical waste (non-hazardous)

Expired non-controlled, non-hazardous specialty product, including cold-chain items.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled, non-hazardous Rx
- OTC & compounded non-haz product
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances
- RCRA-hazardous drugs
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 05

Sharps

From patient self-injection support and in-pharmacy administration.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Immunization needles & syringes
- Lancets
- Point-of-care testing sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-sharp meds
- Bloody gauze (biohazard)

THE RULE · OSHA — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers; annual training if staff are exposed.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Immunizing pharmacies generate more sharps than they expect — size accordingly.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The specialty pharmacy compliance checklist.

- ☐ Reverse distribution set up — returnables credited, the rest destroyed.
- ☐ Controlled substances: Form 222/41 completed, non-retrievable destruction.
- ☐ Cold-chain and biologic product handled per manufacturer and destruction requirements.
- ☐ RCRA-hazardous drugs (P/U-listed + characteristic) identified and segregated.
- ☐ Non-hazardous pharmaceutical waste destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction and return records retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS SPECIALTY PHARMACIES ASK

Your specialty pharmacy questions, answered.

Can we recover credit on expensive biologics?

Yes — returnable high-cost specialty product often carries meaningful manufacturer credit through reverse distribution. It's worth far more than writing it off.

How do we handle hazardous specialty and oncology drugs?

Identify RCRA-hazardous agents (P/U-listed and characteristic), segregate them, and destroy to EPA standards. We'll help you flag which of your products qualify.

What about controlled specialty drugs?

Destroyed non-retrievable with Form 222/41 through our DEA-registered reverse distribution.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle handles pharmacy waste by prepaid mail-back or scheduled pickup for higher volume. Returnable Rx is processed for manufacturer credit; controlled and non-controlled waste is destroyed non-retrievable with a Certificate of Destruction. Form 222/41 handled. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Returnable Rx	Reverse distribution (credit recovery)
Controlled substances	Controlled kit / reverse distribution (Form 222/41)
RCRA-hazardous drugs	RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit
Non-hazardous Rx	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back suits many specialty sites; higher volume or multi-site programs often prefer scheduled pickup and centralized reverse distribution. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.



WHY SPECIALTY PHARMACIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your specialty pharmacy waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop